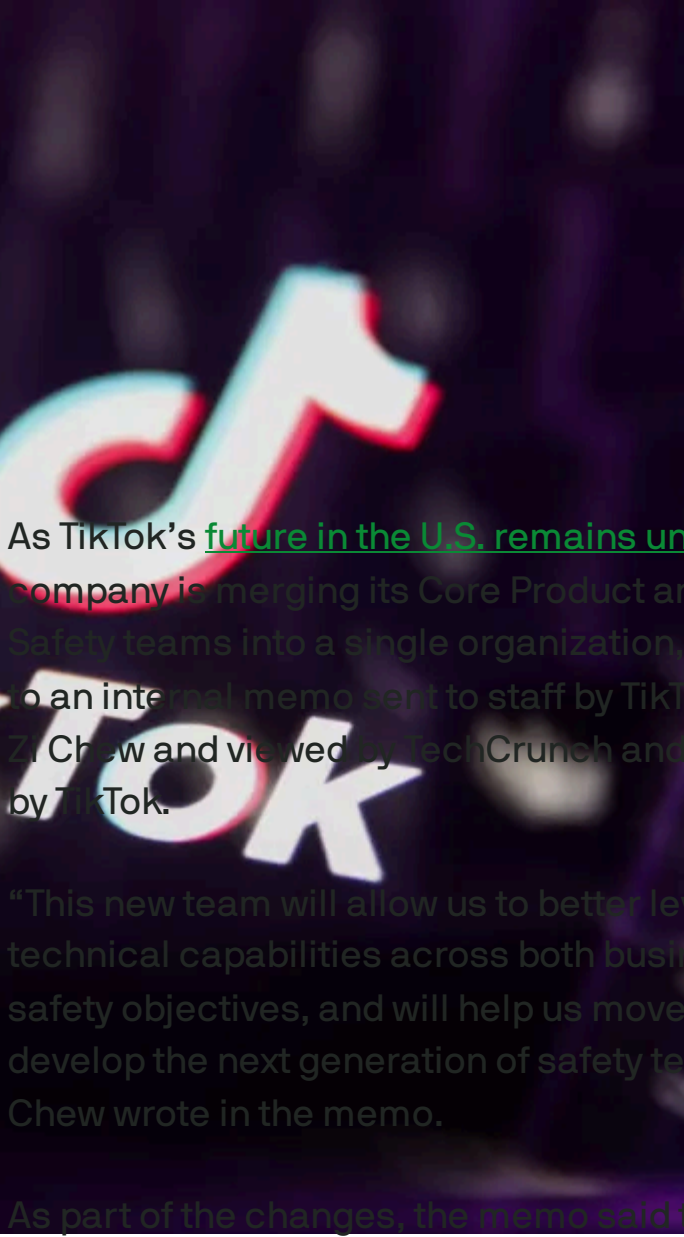


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TikTok merges its Core Product and Trust & Safety teams



As TikTok's future in the U.S. remains uncertain, the company is merging its Core Product and Trust & Safety teams into a single organization, according to an internal memo sent to staff by TikTok CEO Shou Zi Chew and viewed by TechCrunch and confirmed by TikTok.

"This new team will allow us to better leverage our technical capabilities across both business and safety objectives, and will help us move faster as we develop the next generation of safety technology," Chew wrote in the memo.

As part of the changes, the memo said that TikTok's head of Operations and Trust & Safety, Adam Presser, will become the general manager of TikTok USDS, a separate entity of TikTok that's tasked with safeguarding U.S. national security interests, TikTok confirmed to TechCrunch.

Andy Bonillo, the current general manager of TikTok USDS, who led the organization's creation and growth, will transition to a new role as senior adviser, reporting to Presser.

The TikTok Operations teams will continue to report directly to Presser, while Sandeep Grover will become the new head of Global Trust & Safety.

Meanwhile, Jenny Zi will become the leader for TikTok Live.

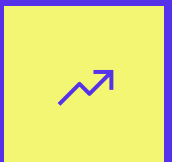
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The reorganization comes as President Trump extended the TikTok shutdown deadline for a third time last month. The [current deadline](#) is September 17.



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U.S. Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick said last week that [TikTok will go dark](#) in the country if China doesn't approve a deal for the sale of the app. Lutnick also stated that the U.S. must control the app's algorithm as part of the sale.

Given the tense situation, which comes in the middle of a tariff war with China, it would not be surprising to see TikTok trying to beef up its USDS team as its U.S. deal hangs in the balance.

"For increased alignment across our robust trust and safety programs, the T&S Product team will now become part of the TikTok Product organization," Chew wrote. "We are creating a new Platform Responsibility team, which will be led by Adam Wang, reporting to Fiona Zhi. Adam has

successfully led the launch and expansion of TikTok LIVE globally over the past four years.”

“I am confident that this reorganization will put us in an even stronger position to match the opportunities ahead of us,” the memo said.

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APPS



TikTok launches its music streaming service in Australia, Mexico and Singapore



TikTok is launching its new subscription-only music streaming service called “TikTok Music” in Australia, Mexico and Singapore. Today’s expansion comes almost two weeks after TikTok [debuted the music streaming service](#) in Brazil and Indonesia.

The streaming service lets users sync the service to their existing TikTok accounts and listen, download and share songs. The service includes the catalogs of major record companies, including Universal Music Group, Warner Music Group and Sony Music.

TikTok says it’s inviting users in Australia, Mexico and Singapore to participate in the TikTok Music closed beta test starting today. To join, users need to download the TikTok Music app from the Apple App Store or Google Play Store or by visiting music.tiktok.com. All participants in the closed beta will receive a three-month free trial of the service.

The company told TechCrunch that a TikTok Music subscription costs AUD11.99 (\$8.16 USD) per month in Australia, Mex\$115 (\$6.86 USD) in Mexico and S\$9.90 (\$7.48 USD) in Singapore.

IMAGE CREDITS:

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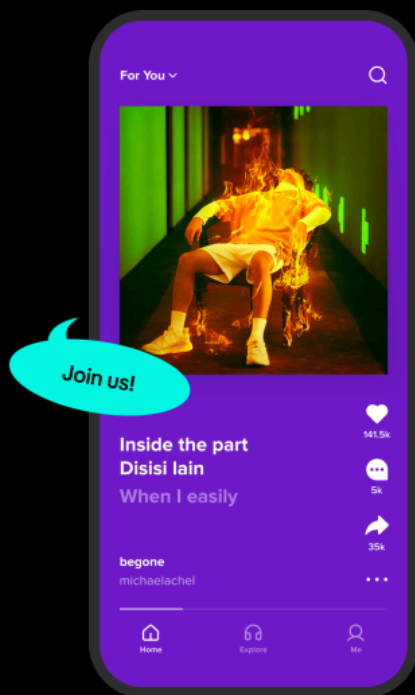


IMAGE CREDITS: TIKTOK

TikTok hasn't shared any details about when it plans to launch the streaming service in the United States, but says it will have more to share about the streaming service soon. It's been over a year since TikTok parent company ByteDance [filed a trademark application](#) with the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office for a service called "TikTok Music."

"TikTok Music is a new kind of music service that combines the power of music discovery on TikTok with a music streaming service offering millions of tracks from thousands of artists," a spokesperson for the company said in an email. "We are now beta testing TikTok Music in Australia, Mexico and Singapore, and will have more news to share on the launch of TikTok Music in the coming months."

TikTok is already a popular tool for discovering music, and oftentimes can lead to songs rising in popularity after they're used in viral videos and trends. By offering users a way to listen to and discover music, the company is directly competing with the likes of Spotify, Apple and Amazon.

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The streaming service lets you listen to full versions of viral TikTok songs, discover personalized music recommendations, access lyrics in real time, create collaborative playlists with friends, import your music library and find songs via a lyrics search feature. TikTok Music features a Shazam-like functionality and also lets you download songs for offline listening. Plus, the service includes social features, as TikTok notes that users can express themselves through comments and connect with other music lovers.

[TikTok launches a music streaming service in Brazil and Indonesia called 'TikTok Music'](#)

Topics: [Apps](#) [music streaming](#) [Social](#) [TikTok](#)

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TikTok launches a music streaming service in Brazil and Indonesia called 'TikTok Music'

Aisha Malik — 10:26 AM PDT · July 6, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS:

PATRICK T. FALLON/AFP / GETTY IMAGES

TikTok has already dominated the short-video and social media market, and is now looking to take on

Spotify and Apple Music with its latest offering.

The company announced today that it's launching a new subscription-only music streaming service called "TikTok Music" in Brazil and Indonesia. TikTok Music lets users sync the service to their existing TikTok accounts and listen, download and share songs. The service includes the catalogs of major record companies, including Universal Music Group, Warner Music Group and Sony Music.

TikTok Music lets you play full versions of viral TikTok songs, discover personalized music recommendations, access lyrics in real time, create collaborative playlists with friends, import your music library and find songs via lyrics search. The service also includes a Shazam-like feature

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Ivan Mehta - 16 minutes ago

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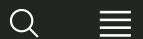
Aisha Malik - 12 hours ago

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The service will replace ByteDance's existing streaming service, Resso, which will shut down on September 5 in Brazil and Indonesia. Resso also operates in India, but TikTok hasn't said when or if TikTok Music will launch in the country.

TikTok Music is here

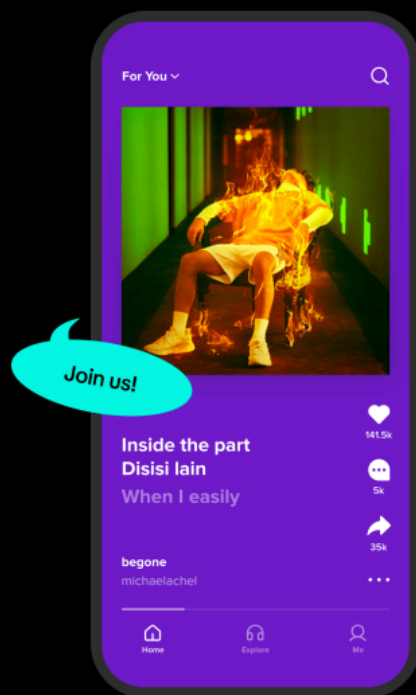


IMAGE CREDITS: TIKTOK

A TikTok Music subscription costs \$3.49 a month in Brazil, and \$3.25 for iOS users in Indonesia. Android users in Indonesia will pay \$2.96 a month for the first year, then \$3.25 afterwards. TikTok Music doesn't include a free membership option, but offers a one-month free trial.

“We are pleased to introduce TikTok Music, a new kind of service that combines the power of music discovery on TikTok with a best-in-class streaming service. TikTok Music will make it easy for people in Indonesia and Brazil to save, download and share their favourite viral tracks from TikTok,” said Ole Obermann, global head of Music Business Development at TikTok, in a statement. “We are excited about the opportunities TikTok Music presents for both music fans and artists, and the great potential it has for driving significant value to the music industry.”

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Today's announcement doesn't come as a surprise, especially since TikTok parent company ByteDance [filed a trademark application](#) with the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office in May 2022 for a service called "TikTok Music."

TikTok is already a popular tool for discovering music, and oftentimes can lead to songs rising in popularity after they're used in viral videos and trends. By offering users a way to listen to and discover music, the company is directly competing with the likes of Spotify, Apple and Amazon. However, it's worth noting that Spotify and Amazon Music offer ad-supported, free memberships.

In order to compete with popular music streaming services, TikTok will have to offer an interface that's worth switching over for, while also providing value for users. For instance, TikTok Music is only slightly cheaper than Spotify Premium in Brazil and Indonesia, so it may be difficult for the company to convince users to choose its service over a competitor's.

Although today's announcement doesn't include anything about podcast and radio content,

ByteDance’s trademark application from last year suggested that the service could be used to “provide users with podcast and radio broadcast content.” The addition of podcast content alongside music would make TikTok Music an even bigger competitor to Apple Music and Spotify.

[After dominating the short-video market, TikTok may be considering a music service](#)

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SOCIAL



TikTok is shutting down its Instagram competitor TikTok Notes

Aisha Malik — 10:06 AM PDT · April 1, 2025

TikTok is shutting down its Instagram competitor, TikTok Notes, on May 8. The [photo-sharing app](#) launched in testing in Canada, Australia, and Vietnam last year.

The company is notifying TikTok Notes users of its decision to retire the app and is directing them to ByteDance-owned [Lemon8](#), which isn't surprising given that the apps are quite similar and offer the same sort of functionality.

IMAGE CREDITS:
JAKUB PORZYCKI / NURPHOTO / GETTY IMAGES

“We’re excited to bring the feedback from TikTok Notes to Lemon8 as we continue building a dedicated space for our community to share and experience photo content, designed to complement and enhance the TikTok experience,” a TikTok spokesperson said in a statement to TechCrunch.

While TikTok didn’t provide a specific reason for shutting down the app, it’s likely that the company didn’t see much adoption for TikTok Notes and is deciding to instead push Lemon8, which had around [12.5 million global monthly active users](#) as of December 2024.

In [a notice to TikTok Notes users](#), TikTok says the decision to shut down the app “was not made lightly.” The notice encourages users to download

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and save their TikTok Notes data and “continue sharing your creativity on Lemon8.” TikTok says that “Lemon8 is a lifestyle app that offers a similar experience to TikTok Notes” but with “even more features.”

Lemon8 launched in Japan in 2020 and later expanded to markets across the U.S. and Southeast Asia. The app is similar to Instagram and Pinterest, as it lets users share slideshows and photo collections and browse content through “Following” and “For You” feeds. Lemon8 offers users access to creative tools, filters, effects, stickers, text templates, and more.

While TikTok is pushing Lemon8 as an alternative to TikTok Notes, ByteDance has also tried to position the app as an alternative to TikTok itself in the face of a potential U.S. ban.

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Last November, the company made it possible for users [to directly access Lemon8](#) with their TikTok accounts and rolled out the ability for users to

cross-share photo content between the apps. The move was seen as a way for ByteDance to move creators onto the new platform without having to get them to sign up for it separately in case TikTok were to go away.

Fast-forward to today, and TikTok continues to promote Lemon8 in its app as it faces a new [ban deadline](#) of April 5.

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